

UPDATED: March 8th, 2026



UNEP - ENERGY DISCOURSE IN EURASIA
BACKGROUND GUIDE
TRITONMUN XXXI – APRIL 12TH, 2026

MODEL UNITED NATIONS AT UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, SAN DIEGO

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HEAD CHAIR LETTER

Greetings, future delegates!

My name is Cyrus (Wesley) Liu, a current third-year undergraduate student at UC San Diego! For those of you who wonder about the type of work I do, I currently hold a major in Political Science in the concentration of International Relations, with a planned double major in Chinese Studies as well as a planned minor in Law and Society! Some of the positions I hold outside of my academics include the Secretary General of Sun God Model United Nations, our organization's collegiate conference, as well as a Student Research/Liason for UC San Diego's Center for Taiwan Studies! I am a proud Taiwanese-American who enjoys cooking, sticking my head in gacha games, and tasting all kinds of boba milk teas! (You will probably catch me drinking a cup a day of...)

Getting into the committee itself, I am honored to serve as your head chair for the 31st rendition of TritonMUN! Starting from my journey of TritonMUN XXVI, I am excited to see the growth of the conference every year as we all bring something new, refreshing, and something interesting for you all to debate about. This committee is no exception; with our focus on energy and environmentalism, it creates a whirlpool of discussion that really shapes the attitude of what our future may look like in the distant future. Additionally, with a new mechanic that we will be adding to our traditional-style General Assembly, I am looking forward to your responses and the adaptability you will need to exercise to keep yourself engaged with the topic. I hope that this committee will bring enrichment, practices in speech giving, and being able to pivot on the spot.

I am looking forward to meeting with you all! Don't be afraid to reach out to me on the day of the committee if you have any questions, and good luck to everyone :D!

Best,

Cyrus (Wesley) Liu

(cy1025@ucsd.edu)

VICE CHAIR LETTER

Future delegates,

My name is Suhani Pawar, and I'm currently a third year student at UC San Diego studying political science with a double major in global health. Outside of my academics, I'm involved in Model United Nations here at UCSD as our co-Director of Media, Technology and Outreach, Students for Global Health, and Seventh College Student Council in its Judicial Board. I also do research with a professor in the political science department about immigration policy. I'm a So-Cal native and I love going to the beach here in San Diego. On campus, you can find me at one of our many coffee shops in the area!

This will be my third year of chairing for UCSD's TritonMUN conference, and I am so excited to meet with you all and learn about your ideas for solving one of the most pressing issues of our time, the consumption of energy and environmentalism. Coming to UCSD and studying climate science through various general education classes has taught me about the heightened importance of issues such as climate change and its impacts on daily life, which is why I look forward to hearing your discussions and solutions on the topic! My hope for you all as delegates is that this topic will push you to think creatively when forming your solutions and make you feel excited to debate various aspects to this deeply complex issue.

If you have any questions about committee, please don't hesitate to reach out to me! I'm looking forward to meeting you all on the day of the conference.

Best,

Suhani Pawar

(spawar@ucsd.edu)

POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

TRITONMUN POSITION PAPER GUIDELINES

- Position Papers are due on **April 3rd at 11:59pm.**
 - Requests for extensions must be sent by the advisor to TritonMUN by **March 22nd.**
- Position Papers must be submitted to the **Google Form** linked here:
 - Position Paper Submission Form: <https://forms.gle/MbtMrAe6TJz9qXmn7>
- Format.
 - Papers should be double-spaced in Times New Roman 12 pt. font and include no pictures.
 - At the top of each paper, include your country/person, name, committee, and topic.
 - Required* Sections: Each of these sections should be clearly labeled
 - Background
 - Past Actions by the Committee (if applicable)
 - Position of your Country/Person
 - Possible Solutions

*Some committees may ask for different formatting or an alternative to a position paper altogether, this will be clearly noted in the background guide for that committee

RULES OF PROCEDURE

Technology:

Electronic devices: Laptops (and other electronic devices) will be allowed only during unmoderated caucuses in order to aid in the facilitation of writing directives.

Special Rules:

Realism: This committee is designed to reflect the complexities of international energy policy. Delegates are expected to remain realistic in their proposals, aligning with the general stance of their respective nations.

Scope of Debate: This committee is strictly focused on energy discourse and infrastructure. This committee is not a forum for discussing active military operations in relevant countries.

Prohibited Actions: To maintain a productive and realistic environment, the introduction of weapons of mass destruction (such as with nuclear strikes) and other types of mass sabotage and destruction are prohibited. Any resolutions shifting the focus to kinetic warfare will be ruled dilatory.

These rules are not so say that you cannot have fun or be creative, but they are here to keep a more focused and realistic approach to the committee, ensuring productive debate and substantive resolution-writing.

DEI AND AI POLICIES

Sensitivity & Harassment Policy:

TritonMUN is committed to fostering a healthy environment for diplomacy and dialogue, and upholding standards of diversity, equity, and inclusion for all delegates. Harassment or disruptive behavior of any kind—whether verbal or non-verbal, in or out of committee—is strictly prohibited. All attendees and staffers should be treated with equal respect, and discrimination on the basis of race, color, gender identity, sexual orientation, religion, nationality, ethnicity, or physical/mental disability will not be tolerated. This list is not exhaustive, and should not be treated as such. **Please report any instances of harassment to conference staff, either directly or through the Anonymous Feedback Form.**

In addition, we acknowledge that topics discussed in-committee may be politically sensitive, particularly in Specialized and Crisis Committees. While we understand that delegates may be immersed in the action and setting of their committee, delegates must maintain decorum and refrain from inflammatory language and actions, even when doing so may be historically accurate to one's character, group, or country. When drafting crisis directives, delegates should refrain from pursuing any action that explicitly violates human rights, including—but not limited to—enslavement and genocide. **Please refer to your committee's background guide for specific sensitivity statements and guidelines, and direct any questions to the committee's head chair.**

All attendants should observe these policies during the entirety of the conference, even outside formal debate, including opening/closing ceremonies, "FUNMUN", etc. Please note that violation of these policies may result in consequences such as disqualification from awards and contact towards the delegate's Advisor. At TritonMUN, our goal has always been focused on the delegate's abilities to enjoy and have fun in committee. However, in order to truly enjoy TritonMUN, delegates must feel safe in committee, which starts with respecting one another.

Plagiarism & Generative AI Policy: TritonMUN recognizes that Model United Nations provides a space for aspiring leaders to showcase their work and abilities, and that all delegates wish to be evaluated in a fair and accurate manner. As such, we expect all delegates to perform with integrity and refrain from plagiarizing the work of their peers. This includes—but is not limited to—claiming the work of another delegate as one’s own, including another bloc’s unique clause without prior approval from the original writer, and replacing another’s work with one’s own (i.e. overwriting).

In addition, delegates are strictly prohibited from utilizing generative AI to produce position papers, resolutions, and directives, in part or in their entirety.

Resolution Work Outside of Committee:

TritonMUN wishes that all delegates use their breaks and downtime as intended: to connect, relax, and refresh. While not in committee, delegates are strictly prohibited from working on resolutions and directives. In addition, this means that pre-writing, or preparing resolutions and directives before the start of the conference, is strictly prohibited.

Technology Policy:

Delegates should expect the use of technology to be limited during committee sessions. Instead of having a universal technology policy for TritonMUN, such policies are individualized for each committee and set by their daises. Please refer to each committee’s background guide to understand their technology policies, and direct any questions to the committee’s head chair. Repercussive actions will be taken at the discretion of the head chair.

KEY TERMS

Energy	The ability to do work, grouped into potential (stored) energy and kinetic (working) energy.
Eurasia	The combined landmass of Europe and Asia, covers approximately 11.2 million km.
Millennium Development Goals (MDGs)	Global framework for collective action for 8 measurable goals including reducing poverty and bettering population health; the MDGs were meant to be completed by 2015.
Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)	Framework for peace and prosperity by 2030; these 17 goals are an urgent call to all countries to work together in global partnership.
Environmentalism	The study of the environment, specifically about the prevention and mitigation of human impact on the world.
Conservation	The protection of the environment from human impact, sustaining limited resources.
Sustainable Development	Progressing economic, social, and environmental growth while preserving systems that don't compromise or harm existing or future natural resources and/or generations of people.
Affordability	The ability for one to cheaply and conveniently access an item or resource.
Global Development	Most commonly accepted as the idea that people from all across the world improve the quality of life and accessibility to resources in an equitable manner.

Equitability	Being fair and just, particularly with regard to accommodating individuals to their conditions.
Greenhouse Gases	The classification of gases produced by human activities (notably carbon dioxide) that contribute to global warming; a primary concern in sustainability.
Energy Efficiency	Utilizing energy in a non-wasteful way, saving external resources from being unnecessarily used.
Resource Adequacy	Being able to maintain a necessary system of input and output of electricity that remains sustainable.
Price Inelastic Demand (Market)	No matter what happens to the demand of a product, the price or unit price remains constant.
Paris Agreement	A legally binding international treaty dedicated to limiting global warming, specifically to hold it below 2°C.

UNEP

INTRODUCTION

Energy is the ability to do work, grouped into potential (stored) energy and kinetic (working) energy, and comes in several different forms. These forms include heat, light, motion, electrical, chemical, and gravitational. Energy and its sources have very strong ties to environmentalism, which will be the focal point of this committee. This is because to be considered ‘clean,’ the energy in question must be renewable, have energy efficiency, and have an efficient combination of heat and power. There are several benefits to clean energy, including reduced air pollution, decreases in greenhouse gas emissions, and improved engine system reliability and security.

The misuse of energy has had significant impacts on environmentalism and other aspects of daily life. When energy is used, the environment, including the air, water, and land we live off of are impacted, and producing and using energy more efficiently reduces the amount of fuel needed and reduces environmental harm. The use of clean energy is especially important because electricity from renewable sources (ex, solar power) does not contribute to climate change or worsen local air pollution. The use of fossil fuels worsens several factors impacting everyday health, including increasing pollution by producing hazardous pollutants and possibly causing acid rain, water pollution with substances such as arsenic and lead, plastic pollution, and oil spills. These factors can worsen health by causing asthma, cancer, heart disease, and premature death. Climate change is worsened by these impacts as well, including ocean acidification from the increased carbon dioxide emissions from fossil fuels, extreme (sometimes deadly) weather events, and rising sea levels that can lead to flooding and saltwater intrusion.

UN INVOLVEMENT

A. SDG 7

What is crucial to the success of energy conservation and its relationship to environmentalism is articulated in a set of goals known as the Sustainable Development Goals. Originally, the United Nations first developed a set of objectives, called the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs). The MDGs were the first ever internationally agreed upon commitment towards a measurable, common goal in the sake of global development. From 2000-2015, the MDGs served as a framework for countries to work towards solving systemic problems, grand crises, and a push for change on the international stage. The MDGs were composed of 8 goals, including poverty reduction, gender equality, and environmental sustainability. Controversially, although this was a massive feat in global unity and the development of international systems and interest in solving these crises, the goals were not met by 2015, and many critics point out the somewhat ineffective nature of the goals and the pressure that the goals have on developing countries. In an effort to continue the efforts of the MDGs, the United Nations revised the goals themselves and separated them into even narrower topics. This development is what transformed into the main set of goals that the United Nations and countries from all over the world standardize today, that being the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs).

From 2015 to 2030, the SDGs have remained the staple for global efforts in the development of citizens and people of different cultures and circumstances worldwide. What separates the MDGs from the SDGs is that the MDGs' main focus of eliminating poverty with a less comprehensive approach to the environment and other factors in global development, whereas the changes made to the SDGs sought to address multiple factors that contribute to sickness, inequity, and the lack of resources in the world. The major focus of eliminating poverty, instead of opting for true sustainable development involving the conservation of the environment, is what can be argued to be the difference in what makes the SDGs such a dominant and well-researched set of rules approved by countries all over the world. Within the SDGs, there exist 17 goals, including:

1. **No Poverty** - The complete and universal eradication of poverty in the world.
2. **Zero Hunger** - The full eradication of hunger in the world.
3. **Good Health and Well-Being** - The encouragement to promote healthy communities and safe environments for living, as well as the development of institutions to sustain the continuation of these practices.
4. **Quality Education** - The assurance for every child on the planet to have the opportunity to receive equitable, quality education that promotes thinking and intelligence.
5. **Gender Equality** - The empowerment of women through the injustices of many societies against them.
6. **Clean Water and Sanitation** - Putting efforts to universally apply equitable access to clean water for drinking and hygiene.
7. **Affordable and Clean Energy** - The assurance of energy efficiency and attainment through cheap and sustainable means.
8. **Decent Work and Economic Growth** - To promote sustainable and rewarding employment for all in support of one's economy, community, and family.
9. **Industry, Innovation, and Infrastructure** - The promotion and funding of tough infrastructure to withstand extreme climates and to foster construction that provides comfortable and sustainable spaces for all.
10. **Reduced Inequalities** - The pledge to decrease inequalities, particularly stressing economic inequities and social discrimination.
11. **Sustainable Cities and Communities** - The promise to fund cities and communities that are both comfortable and sustainable for all.
12. **Responsible Consumption and Production** - Ensuring that the products and services of each nation are both sustainable and safe for all consumers.
13. **Climate Action** - The assurance to further combat climate change through means of lessening carbon emissions, creating and investing in cleaner energy sources, and furthering practices that protect the environment.
14. **Life Below Water** - The conservation of sea animals, plants, and overall life through various protective measures.
15. **Life On Land** - The conservation of land animals, plants, and overall life through various protective measures.

16. **Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions** - The establishment of protective institutions by means of promoting justice and accountability for actors who have wronged or hurt one another.

17. **Partnerships for the Goals** - The promise to continue its progress by collaborating with other organizations and communities, promoting mutual benefits and understanding across multiple states and cultures.

(As a clarification for the committee, we will be primarily focused on discussing SDG 7; however, you are free to discuss and tie in whichever other SDG you see fit in your discussion towards energy. SDGs by nature are intersectional, meaning that they can cross and affect the status of another.)



SDG Chart. Image from:

<https://social.desa.un.org/issues/disability/sustainable-development-goals-sdgs-and-disability>

For the focus of energy, SDG 7 has been created in an effort to make the first universal objective towards a cleaner and more sustainable use of energy. As described by the United Nations, SDG 7 was proposed in the hopes of “target[ing] access[ibility], efficiency, renewables and means of implementation. Ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern

energy for all is crucial for achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, from its role in the eradication of hunger and poverty, through advancements in health, education, inclusive growth, sustainable cities, water supply, infrastructure, industrialization, etc., to combating climate change”. Crucially, for the discussion on conserving energy and utilizing it in more sustainable ways, this is the general framework that countries and non-governmental actors use to kickstart programs like Non-governmental organizations (NGOs) or governmental outreach to bring the world one step closer towards sustainable development. Most notably, SDG 7 has been one of the more successful objectives in the world regarding progress and plausibility in the implementation of clean energy policies all around the globe, such as increasing accessibility to electricity from 87% to 92%. However, according to the United Nations, the original goal of universal access seems not to be within reach by 2030 if there are no significant changes or policy implementations of countries to continue to trek towards electricity accessibility.

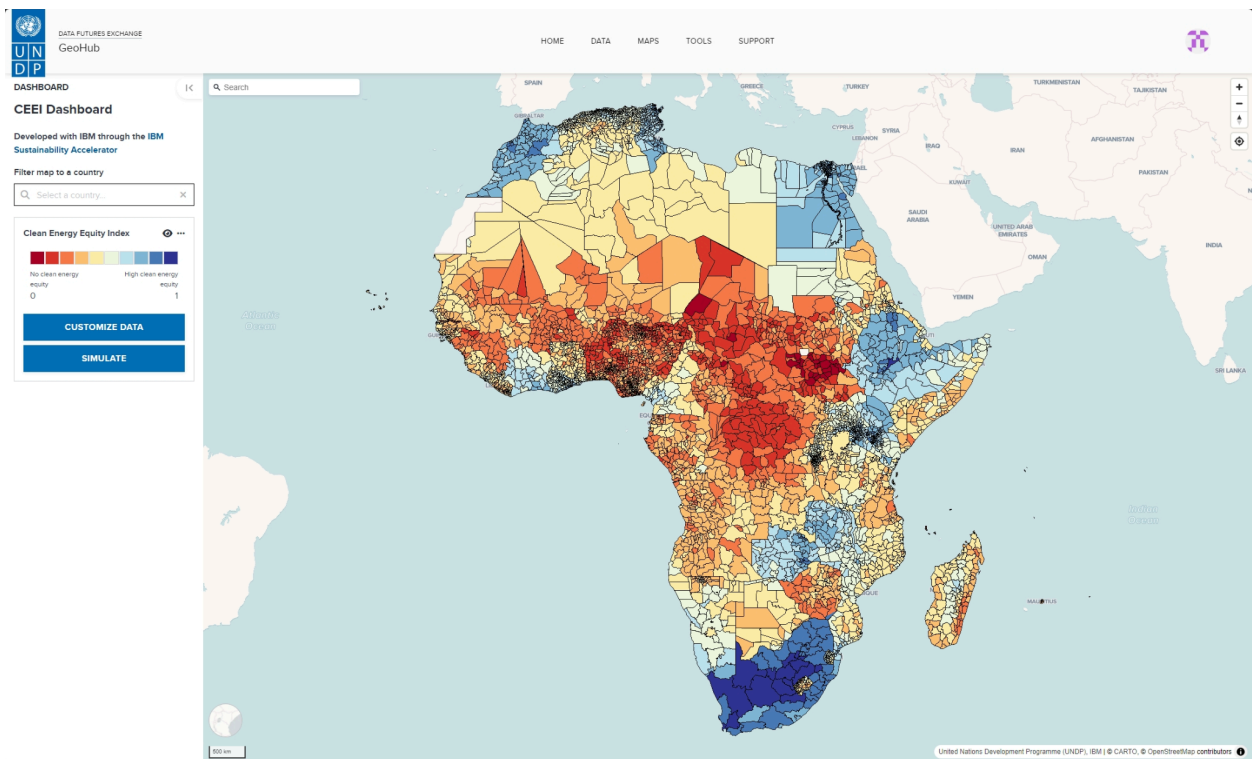
B. UNDP - Sustainable Energy Hub

With the development of the SDGs, there came the opportunity for the United Nations to create institutions within the organization to formulate agencies and collaboration amongst the countries in the United Nations. This set of agencies is called the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). Particularly, the way that the UNDP is structured and divided under 6 core solutions: Poverty, Governance, Resilience, Environment, Energy, and Gender Equality.

In the concentration of this committee, the UNDP department with the greatest relations to the topic at hand would be the Sustainable Energy Hub. The major mission of the Sustainable Energy Hub, in coordination with the achievement of SDG 7, is to work towards a net-zero emissions world by following the framework of the Paris Agreement. The general direction of the Sustainable Energy Hub can be broken down into three different parts: equitable access to electricity and energy, the promotion of using sustainable energy practices, and dealing with scaling proper investments to fund the proper notions for building the needed infrastructure and entities needed to deliver and service energy.

To highlight some of the tools that the Sustainable Energy Hub uses to aid other countries in achieving can be highlighted by two made publicly available by the United Nations. The first is a compilation of data known as the Clean Energy Equity Index, or the CEEI. As described by

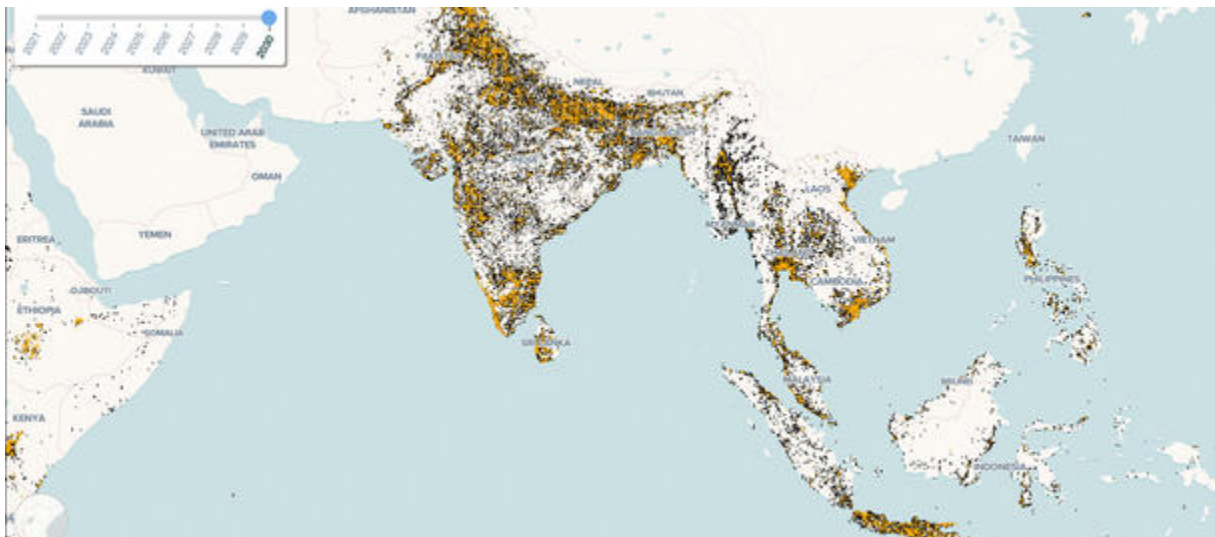
the Sustainable Energy Hub, it is a “cloud-based geospatial tool” that highlights countries based on their readiness in transitioning into using clean energy, and whether the resources of the countries are enough to sustain the transition. The measure of the map itself is from a scale of 0 to 1, where 0 represents a country’s complete inequitable distribution of clean energy, and 1 represents a very high and equitable distribution of clean energy. To call attention to the main considerations the Sustainable Energy Hub uses to determine if a country scores from 0 to 1, they use “social, economic, and environmental equitability”, quantifying and organizing this information into the CEEI. The quantified variables, alongside the graphic created through this program, are used in numerous different simulations and prediction models for countries to develop conclusions and recommendations in the next steps forward.



Screenshot of the CEEI. Image from: <https://docs.undpgeohub.org/dashboards/ceei/>

The second tool utilized by the Sustainable Energy Hub is the Forecasting Electricity Access dataset (FEA). As the name of this dataset suggests, it operates as a predictive model that details the accessibility of energy and electricity to participating countries in the United Nations, particularly countries that are on track to progress towards SDG 7 in having universal

accessibility to energy. Some of the major variables that this dataset tracks include the accessibility of citizens to electricity by individual districts, cities, and countries, the current trends of the accessibility of energy for citizens of both the past, present, and future, and the effects of energy accessibility from other factors relating to environmentalism. As detailed by the United Nations, they utilize a combination of “population, infrastructure, urbanization, elevation, land use”, etc. in their analysis of energy accessibility. A main takeaway from this dataset is the relationship between energy accessibility and wealth, which, as evidenced by this variable as the main comparison point of energy accessibility, proves to be another contributing factor and important discussion point when planning new initiatives in accomplishing the goals of SDG 7.



Screenshot of the FEA. Image from: <https://www.undp.org/energy>

C. Relations to Conflict and Criticism

Despite the United Nations' claim to unity with the SDGs, many impactful implications come with not only the implementation of the SDGs in individual countries, but also if these sets of rules are effective in the first place, with the SDGs being a non-legally binding treaty by the General Assembly. This falls into two distinct arguments and criticisms of SDG 7 and the goals of sustainability: 1) "Green" or sustainable energy itself can be a target for conflict, serving as a vulnerability that other actors can manipulate to endanger national security, and 2) the system of SDGs and the policies enacted by the United Nations have been simultaneously ineffective in addressing global development challenges as well as being so vague in its' legal structure that there is no unity or collaboration incentivized for states to take action.

Naturally, with just how vital energy is to living and survivability, it often becomes a major vulnerability to actors that seek to target or harm another. With the targeting of energy and the abolishment of it during war and conflict, it hinders global development, shuts public and private institutions such as schools and hospitals, and weakens citizens' livelihoods and survivability, shutting basic functions like cooking, heat, or even basic telecommunications. In the case where a military operation targets energy centers or efforts in hindering green, renewable, affordable energy for the citizenry, this further contributes to disease, hunger, and many other demerits. This is additionally exacerbated by the repair process as well, where, like the example of Ukraine, Syria, and Yemen, the mending of the country's energy crisis after an actor's military advance required years of labor and state finances, contributing to the crippling of their economy and citizens' livelihoods. Relating to SDG 7, the development of such energy efficiencies and the disruptive technologies that arise out of these investments poses a vulnerable target for other actors to attack, dissuading developing nations and war-prone countries from pushing revolutionary policies regarding energy conservation.

Transitioning to the 2nd point, there are also deep conversations of both the issues in the accomplishments of SDGs, the possibility of the goals being achieved before 2030 actually comes by, as well as the way the SDGs pave the way for a lack of progress with its' vague framework and, as the weakness of any international law, the inability to reinforce and continue the trek of progress of the SDGs. One of the greatest challenges posed towards SDGs is just

simply how slow the progress of SDGs are on the world, with none of the SDGs having been completed 4 years before hitting 2030 (as of now), where only around 35% of goals are actually on track towards achieving the set goals. This is further dire when 18% of these goals were instead regressing, an unfortunate reality of the bare achievements of the SDGs. This doesn't simply extend to SDG 7 either, where there are still millions of people in poverty, women's rights are still in a critical state all across the globe, and climate change is only getting worse year by year, with 2024 reporting to be one of the hottest and most influential, as well as carbon emissions being the highest it has been in 2 million years. Furthermore, with recent events like the COVID-19 pandemic, many have lost trust in the actions and goals made by the United Nations regarding public health and protection, where civilians and governments began to question the effectiveness of the SDGs, and whether it truly contributes to global development. Additionally, the weaknesses of the SDGs themselves fall under the vagueness of the system itself, where actors can utilize these missions in their own interpretive meanings, whether it truly benefits the original intent of the objectives or not.

CASE STUDIES

California Electricity Crisis of 2020

In the United States, each state differs from the next. By state size, the largest states in the U.S. are Alaska, Texas, California, Montana, and others. With large states, one can almost assume that there is a direct correlation with population. With that being said, the largest states in terms of population include California, Texas, Florida, New York, and so on. There is a distinguishable similarity when it comes to both lists. That being said, California resides in the top 3 states in both terms of population and size. With this, it almost seems obvious that the use of electricity in California is imperative, suggesting a large and rather demanding use of electricity and energy. With that being said, it is no surprise that over half of the electricity consumption in California is fueled by natural gas alone. To further add, California is credited, at least in 2024, to use an approximate 14% of hydroelectric power, while the rest comes from a small percentage of renewable energy sources, and an even smaller percentage use of nuclear energy. With this, California, with no surprise, contains the second-highest total energy consumption per capita in the nation alone.

Even with these facts, California is not perfect. During the early 21st century, California was in place to suffer a number of consecutive power outages. Rather than having the necessary supplies to tackle this issue, California had to be reliant and dependent on other states. Because of droughts in the Pacific Northwest, the prices of electricity made it difficult for companies to have a desire to sell in California. With these issues blooming, California was forced into emergency measures, resulting in fewer electrical issues to occur. Even with these preventative measures, California still faced issues. In 2011 alone, California suffered a power outage in the San Diego area, resulting in an approximate 1.4 million individuals to lose access to power. The consequences were, in short, detrimental to California's reputation. In principle, electric companies were forced to take their own actions for this issue. Electric companies, primarily in California, were forced to integrate grid modernization systems to obtain a more powerful control over the flow of electricity, especially to tackle the spikes in demand for electricity. As for citizens, other than the obvious anger and backlash coming from individuals, there became a

serious concern over the overall health of many. For example, many elderly, children, and individuals with special needs require electricity. Whether it is for heating, cooling, or health systems, a loss of electricity can cause the potential of a health harm. This, unfortunately, leaves many of these individuals in a citation where it can be detrimental to their health.

Yet, even with all these present solutions to solve issues like the ones above from happening, California still suffers from loss of power in the modern era. In 2020, the California Independent System Operator (CAISO), California Public Utilities Commission (CPUC), and California Energy Commission (CEC) all issued a “Final Root Cause Analysis” of the continuous heat waves and outages in August of 2020. Within this analysis, CAISO, CPUC, and CEC all identified that extreme weather conditions, market practices, resource adequacy, and planning processes were all related and impacted the power outages that were occurring in August. Because of these unfortunate circumstances, the state was unable to effectively, as expected, to provide energy to millions of residents. This further became an issue due to the inability to import energy from neighboring states, resulting in prolonged consequences. Yet, even with these issues at hand, CAISO, CPUC, and CEC all have taken a number of actions to prepare California for another incident like this one. This includes opening an Emergency Reliability rulemaking, a continued analysis of supporting functions, an expediting process to consider the market, a looking at progress for battery storage projects, and so on. Along with this, the CEC has been heavily looking towards the future. This includes leading the state to a future with only the usage of clean energy.



Graphic of 2020 Crisis. Image from: [Tag: California Blackouts 2020](#)

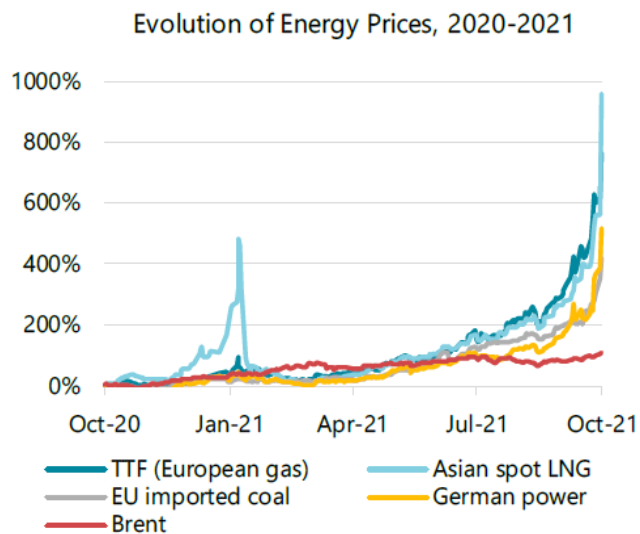
Global Energy Crisis of 2021-2022

Global demand for energy dropped to historic lows during the pandemic, but the sudden return to daily life in 2021 ushered in a rapid increase in energy use, stressing global energy supplies as energy markets struggled to keep up. This led to record-high natural gas prices, the highest since 2008, and as a result, increased electricity costs. However, unlike previous energy crises, this crisis was not limited to one sector of energy or one geographical region, rather impacting the entire global market, from oil to liquified natural gas (LNG). The interconnectedness of today's markets resulted in the elevation of this crisis to the global scale, as for instance, European nations import coal from South Africa, Colombia, and Australia, LNG from the United States, and petroleum oil from Kazakhstan and the Middle East.

This crisis was further exacerbated by a variety of external factors that stretched energy supplies. Many European nations had been decommissioning coal plants to hit climate targets and transition to green energy sources such as hydropower and nuclear energy. However, the driest summer in 500 years hit Europe in 2022, drying out water reservoirs, “threaten[ing] nuclear reactors in France, and crimp[ing] coal transport in Germany.” Brazil, China, and California faced similar challenges with record droughts threatening hydropower generation. Additionally, Russia began withholding its gas supplies to Europe in 2021, even though the EU imported 45% of its gas from Russia alone at the time. All of this combined led to a decrease in energy supply while demand for energy remained relatively stable, as energy is a price-inelastic good.

As energy is a baseline necessity for all major industries globally, starting from production and manufacturing, this crisis had widespread impacts across critical industries including agriculture. Food prices had already risen during the pandemic and further increased as fertilizer production relies on natural gas, and the agricultural industry directly uses energy for irrigation, farm machinery, packaging, and transportation, and indirectly uses energy for pesticides and mineral fertilizers. This led to increased food and electricity insecurity, and “higher energy bills have increased extreme poverty,” intensifying the socioeconomic impacts caused by the pandemic for many households. This set back progress towards UN SDG 7, which aims for universal and affordable access to clean energy.

To combat the supply shortage and relieve price pressures, coal consumption increased by 14% in Europe, and global consumption rose to over 8 billion tons for the first time in history. To increase gas supplies, Europe turned to Algeria, Norway, and Azerbaijan while vowing to consume energy more efficiently. China, the US, and Qatar also posed as potential LNG suppliers to Europe, but with the high investment costs and demand for LNG, it is not the most cost-effective import alternative for many nations. Many countries also opted to subsidize fuel prices, reduce carbon emissions taxes, and ease gas taxes to combat inflationary pressures on individual consumers, but this could only serve as a short-term solution as it strained national budgets and increased pressure on finding green alternatives to not further strain progress toward goals set in the Paris Agreement (namely the 1.5°C climate warming threshold). Conversely, on a positive note, a 2023 analysis by The Economist showed that this crisis had actually “fast-tracked the green transition by an astonishing five to ten years,” strengthening progress toward UN SDG 13 (climate action).



Graphical Model of Energy Prices

2020-2021. Image from: [Energy crisis could threaten global economic recovery, says IEA | Reuters](#)

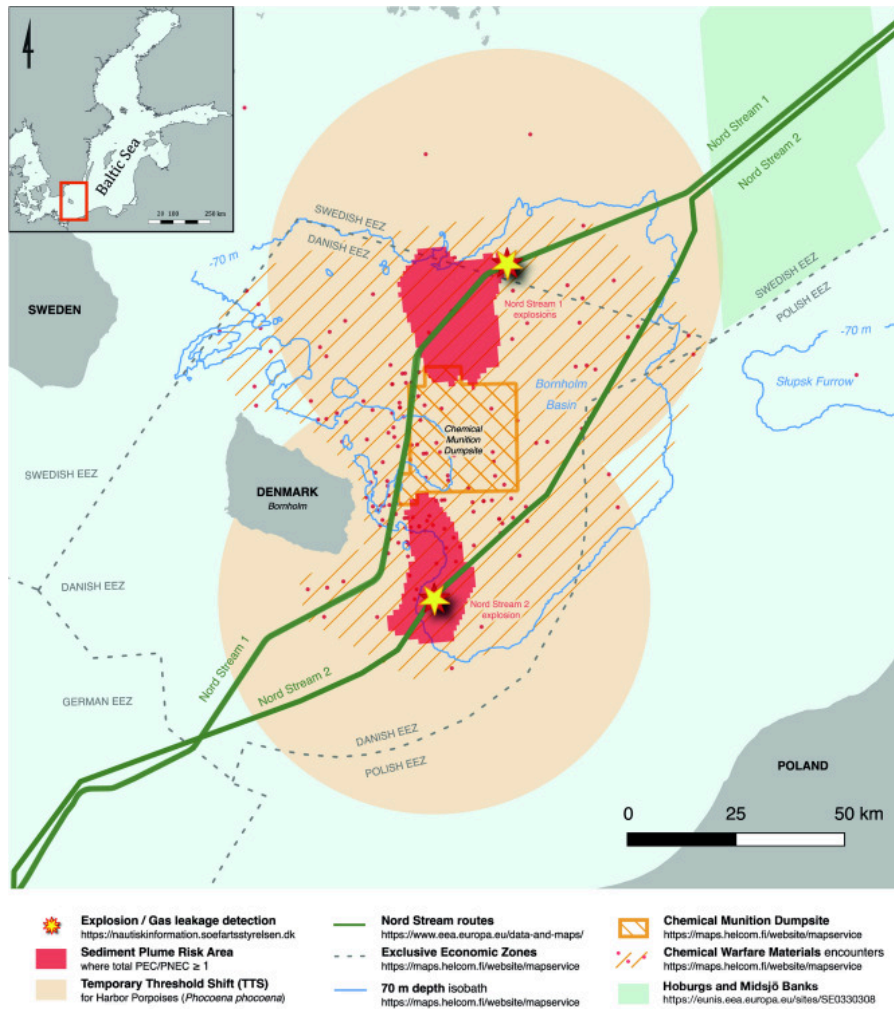
Russia-European Union Gas Dispute of 2022

Russia, as of 2022, was responsible for a large percentage of the European Union's (EU) natural gas, making up to 45% of their imports. Up until early 2022, the rest of Europe and Russia were in a mutually beneficial situation: the EU could benefit from the source of secure energy, while Russia could continue to sell its natural gases to its biggest customer. With such a big volume of imports coming from Russia, and with so many countries using natural gases as a primary energy source, the reliance Europe had on Russian oil imports was made abundantly clear. Following the 2022 energy dispute, Europe has made the effort to divert their sources of energy away from the Russian Federation, the catalyst being the Russian-EU 2022 gas dispute.

Gazprom is Russia's largest natural gas producer, and was responsible for many major gas pipelines leading into Europe, including Nord Stream 1, TurkStream, and Yamal-Europe. Following the Russian invasion of Ukraine in February 2022, Russian President Vladimir Putin announced that all payments made for Russian oil and gas must be made in rubles. Countries including the United Kingdom and Germany made statements that they did not have the intention of going through with this method of payment, which would directly contribute to Russia's economy during the invasion of Ukraine. Following this, in late March 2022, gasflow from the Yamal-Europe pipeline slowed to a near zero whilst Nord Stream 1 stayed unaffected, despite claims from Gazprom that there were simply supply disruptions as a result of the currency change arrangement.

Over the following months, more European countries experienced gas line cutoffs as a result of their failure to pay their fees in rubles. A major cut-off happened in May, when the Gas Transmissions Systems Operator Ukraine (GTSOU) halted flow from the Russian-occupied Sokhranivka transit point in Luhansk. Dwindling supply over time decreased Russia's output of natural gas to Europe to ~20% of what it was before. In late September 2022, underwater explosions occurred on Nord Stream 1 and 2, damaging three out of four of the pipelines within international waters near Bornholm. These explosions are said to be due to foul play, but alongside the geopolitical implications, the additional impact of the explosion of Nord Stream 1 and 2 was heavy gas contamination. The natural gases released into the atmosphere contributed to the effects of climate change, and marine life surrounding the explosions was negatively

impacted. After the explosions, marine life in the immediate surrounding area, a radius of four kilometers, were at risk of death and within 50 kilometers at risk of temporary hearing loss. Additionally, the impact resuspended 250000 metric tons of contaminated sediment on the ocean floor, resulting in long-lasting toxicological impact on other marine flora and fauna.



Map of affected area.

Image from:

[Environmental impact of the explosion of the Nord Stream pipelines](#)

COMMITTEE MECHANICS

One mechanic unique to this General Assembly will be the inclusion of a “crisis” update that will change the tides and attitudes of the committee. For those who have not done a crisis committee before, a “crisis” update will announce a fictional situation, where, for the context of this committee, a global emergency of some kind will take place. The delegate’s job will be to adapt to this emergency and plan solutions to fix the problem, alongside facilitating the main conversation at hand. **The “crisis” update should aid and supplement your resolution.** Although delegates should embrace the change and debate accordingly, it is important to stress that the conversation will still center around energy use and environmentalism. **You, as the delegate, may choose to pivot or remain with the same agenda for your country, depending on the context of the “crisis” arc.** After the “crisis” update has been announced, the committee will resume as a normal General Assembly. The core mechanics of the General Assembly, including but not limited to the speaker's list, resolutions, and authors’ panel, will not change.

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

- 1) What would your country's stance be on not only the state of how SDGs are followed on the international stage, but also what other non-members should be held accountable to those same goals?
 - 2) How would your country advocate for universally creating opportunities for clean energy? Will your country support SDG 7's goals?
 - 3) How would you communicate and solidify your country's perspective and incorporate it within a group of diverse viewpoints?
 - 4) Which countries would be best in the aid of your country's position regarding these matters? Will you set aside and compromise, or stand on the grounds of your country's policies?
 - 5) Should you and your block utilize existing institutions by the United Nations to support sustainable energy usage? Or is the creation of a new unit more impactful?
 - 6) How will your country promote efficient energy usage, with many of its policies and development being tied to war and international politics?
 - 7) Will your country be supporting the Eurasian continent with a push for the usage of cleaner energy? If so, how?
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